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Book Clubs Website - Comprehensive Online Reading Community Platform

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ABSTRACT

1.1 Problem Background

The digital reading landscape has evolved rapidly, yet book enthusiasts face significant challenges in connecting with like-minded readers. Traditional book clubs are limited by geography, scheduling conflicts, and lack of scalable platforms for discussion. Existing online reading communities often lack structured organization and easy access to book discovery tools. Readers struggle to find relevant clubs, search for specific books efficiently, and maintain organized reading lists. This gap creates fragmented experiences where users cannot effectively discover books, save favorites, or create their own reading communities that match their preferences.

1.2 Objective of the Project

To develop a comprehensive web-based Book Clubs platform that enables users to search books, create/join clubs, save favorites, and connect with readers. The platform provides essential community tools with seamless authentication and intuitive book discovery features.

1.3 Proposed Solution

The Book Clubs website is a full-stack web application built using the MERN stack (MongoDB, Express.js, React.js, Node.js). It features user authentication, book search integration with 3rd party APIs, club creation tools, and favorites management. The major components include Login/Signup Module, Book Search Engine, Club Management System, Favorites Collection, and User Profile Dashboard. These modules work together to provide a straightforward platform where users can search books instantly, save favorites, create/join clubs, and build reading communities efficiently.

1.4 Key Features or Functionality

Core features include book search using 3rd party APIs (Google Books/Open Library), secure login/signup with JWT, add-to-favorites functionality, create-your-own-club tools, join existing clubs by invitation code, basic club discussion boards, personal reading lists, and simple member management. Users can organize their reading journey with intuitive search, personalized favorites, and community building capabilities.

1.5 Technology / Method Used

Developed using MERN stack with MongoDB for data storage, Node.js/Express.js for APIs, React.js for frontend, and 3rd party book APIs for search functionality. JWT handles secure authentication while responsive design ensures cross-device compatibility.

1.6 Expected Outcome & Benefits

The platform will enable easy book discovery, organized favorites collection, and simple club creation across geographic boundaries. Readers gain instant access to millions of books, maintain personal reading lists, and build communities effortlessly. Publishers benefit from increased book visibility through integrated search APIs.

1.7 Original Contribution Statement

This platform integrates 3rd party book search APIs with simple club creation tools, providing accessible reading community organization for all users.

1.8 Implementation Status

The Book Clubs platform has been successfully implemented as a full-stack web application. The frontend is developed using React.js, providing a responsive and user-friendly interface, while the backend APIs built with Node.js and Express.js handle authentication and core operations. Key functionalities such as user registration, login, book search, club creation/joining, and favorites management are fully operational, demonstrating smooth frontend-backend integration.

1.9 Future Scope

The future scope of the Book Clubs platform includes adding real-time features such as live discussions and notifications, implementing likes and comments within clubs, enhancing user profile functionality, and improving recommendation systems. Additionally, deploying backend services on cloud platforms will enhance scalability, performance, and accessibility for a larger user base.